

مکمل کاشمری تہ آواز نشان

Complete Kashmiri Perso-Arabic Alphabet

A Unicode-ready reference for reading, teaching, keyboard design and the Kashur Editor

ا، آ، اُ، ب، پ، ت، ٹ، ث، ج، چ، ح، خ، د، ڈ، ذ، ر، ڑ، ز، ژ، س،
ش، ص، ض، ط، ظ، ع، غ، ف، ق، ک، گ، ل، م، ن، ں، و، وِ، وِہ،
ھ، ی، یِ، یِہ

What “complete” means here: Kashmiri uses 21 basic native consonants, 13 additional consonants mainly for loanwords, 6 aspirated consonant combinations, the dedicated Kashmiri Yeh for palatalisation, 16 explicitly written vowel sounds, nasalisation signs, digits and punctuation.

21 basic consonants

ب، پ، ت، د، ٹ، ڈ، ک، گ، ژ، چ، ج،
س، ز، ش، ہ، م، ن، و، ر، ل، ی

These represent the standard consonant sounds of modern Kashmiri.

13 additional consonants

ط، ق، خ، غ، ع، ف، ص، ث، ذ، ض، ظ،
ح، ڑ

Mostly retained in Arabic, Persian and Urdu loanwords.

6 aspirated combinations

پھ، تھ، ڈھ، ژھ، چھ، کھ

Each is encoded as a base consonant followed by ھ (U+06BE).

Kashmiri palatalisation

ی

□ **U+0620 ARABIC LETTER KASHMIRI YEH** follows the consonant it palatalises.

Essential vowel carriers and letter forms

ا، آ، اُ، اِ، وِ، وِہ، یِہ، یِ

Core Unicode rule: use ی for Kashmiri Yeh, not یِ. For the long central vowel use the sequence اِ (U+0627 U+065F); the precomposed character اِ (U+0673) is deprecated by Unicode.

Consonant reference

Letter	Unicode	Value	Use
ب	U+0628	b	Basic consonant
پ	U+067E	p	Basic consonant
ت	U+062A	t	Basic consonant
د	U+062F	d	Basic consonant
ٹ	U+0679	ʈ / ʈ	Retroflex basic consonant
ڊ	U+0688	ɖ / ɖ	Retroflex basic consonant
ک	U+06A9	k	Basic consonant; prefer KEHEH, not Arabic KAF U+0643
گ	U+06AF	g	Basic consonant
ژ	U+0698	ts	Basic Kashmiri affricate
چ	U+0686	ch / tʃ	Basic consonant
ج	U+062C	j / dʒ	Basic consonant
س	U+0633	s	Basic consonant
ز	U+0632	z	Basic consonant
ش	U+0634	sh / ʃ	Basic consonant
ه	U+06C1	h	Basic consonant; HEH GOAL
م	U+0645	m	Basic consonant
ن	U+0646	n	Basic consonant and medial nasalisation base
و	U+0648	w / v	Basic consonant and vowel carrier
ر	U+0631	r	Basic consonant
ل	U+0644	l	Basic consonant
ی	U+06CC	y / j	Basic consonant and vowel carrier; FARSI YEH

Additional consonants, aspirates and special signs

Letter	Unicode	Value	Use
ش	U+062B	s	Loanword spelling
ح	U+062D	h / h	Loanword spelling
خ	U+062E	kh / x	Loanword consonant; also represents an aspirated sound in some words
ذ	U+0630	z	Loanword spelling
ڑ	U+0691	r / ɽ	Retroflex consonant, especially in foreign words
ص	U+0635	s	Loanword spelling
ض	U+0636	z	Loanword spelling
ط	U+0637	t	Loanword spelling
ظ	U+0638	z	Loanword spelling
ع	U+0639	' / carrier	Loanword consonant and occasional vowel carrier
غ	U+063A	gh	Loanword spelling
ف	U+0641	f	Loanword spelling
ق	U+0642	q	Loanword spelling

Aspirated consonants

Form	Sequence	Value
پھ	067E 06BE	ph / p ^h
تھ	062A 06BE	th / t ^h
ٹھ	0679 06BE	ṭh / ṭ ^h
ٹھ	0698 06BE	tsh / ts ^h
چھ	0686 06BE	chh / tʃ ^h
کھ	06A9 06BE	kh / k ^h

Special consonant and nasal signs

Form	Unicode	Function
ی	U+0620	Kashmiri Yeh: palatalises the preceding consonant
ں	U+06BA	Word-final nasalisation
ن	0646 0652	Medial nasalisation
ھ	U+06BE	HEH DOACHASHMEE used in aspirated combinations
ء	U+0621	Hamza used in loanwords and orthographic combinations

The 16 written Kashmiri vowel sounds

Kashmiri is alphabetic in its use of Perso-Arabic script: vowel sounds are normally written explicitly. Initial vowels use a carrier; medial and final vowels use letters, combining marks, or both.

Sound	Initial	Medial	Final	Preferred Unicode sequence
a	آ	ب	ب	0627 064E / 064E
ā / a:	آ	ا	ا	0622 / 0627
ə	آ	ب	ب	0623 or 0627 0654 / 0654
ē / e:	آ	آ	آ	0672
i	ا	ب	ب	0627 0650 / 0650
ī / i:	ای	ی	ی	0627 06CC 0656 / 06CC 0656 / 06CC
ɨ	ا	ب	ب	0625 or 0627 0655 / 0655
ī / i:	ا	ب	ب	0627 065F / 065F
u	ا	ب	ب	0627 064F / 064F
ū / u:	او	و	و	0627 0648 0657 / 0648 0657
e	ای	ی	ے	0627 06CC 065A / 06CC 065A / 06D2 065A
ē / e:	ای	ی	ے	0627 06CC / 06CC / 06D2
o	او	و	و	0627 0648 065A / 0648 065A
ō / o:	او	و	و	0627 0648 / 0648
ɔ	او	و	و	0627 06C4 / 06C4
ō / ɔ:	او	وا	وا	0627 06C4 0627 / 06C4 0627

Do not encode the short o vowel as ۆ merely because it looks similar. For interoperable Kashmiri text, use ۆ (U+0648 U+065A). Software may recognise legacy alternatives during import, but the editor should produce the preferred sequence.

Combining marks, digits and punctuation

 U+064E Fatha	 U+064F Damma	 U+0650 Kasra
 U+0654 Hamza above; Kashmiri ə	 U+0655 Hamza below; Kashmiri ĩ	 U+0656 Subscript alef; long ī
 U+0657 Inverted damma; long ū	 U+065A Small V above; short e/o	 U+065F Wavy hamza below; long ï
 U+0652 Sukun/Jazm	 U+0651 Shadda; consonant doubling	 U+0670 Superscript alef in loanwords

Kashmiri digits

۹ ۸ ۷ ۶ ۵ ۴ ۳ ۲ ۱ ۰

Use the Extended Arabic-Indic range U+06F0–U+06F9. In particular, use ٦ U+06F6 rather than Arabic-Indic ٦ U+0666.

Punctuation for a complete editor keyboard

Symbol	Unicode	Name/use
،	U+060C	Arabic comma
؛	U+061B	Arabic semicolon
؟	U+061F	Arabic question mark
۔	U+06D4	Arabic full stop used in Urdu-style text
٪	U+066A	Arabic percent sign
٫	U+066B	Decimal separator
؁	U+066C	Thousands separator

Production checklist for the Kashur Editor

Requirement	Correct implementation
Language metadata	Set Kashmiri editable text to lang="ks" dir="rtl" so fonts can select Kashmiri-specific glyph forms.
Text storage	Store Unicode characters, never presentation-form glyphs or image-based letters.
Kashmiri Yeh	Use ೀ U+0620. Do not substitute ು U+06CD.
Kashmiri Kaf	Use ೂ U+06A9. Avoid silently replacing it with Arabic ك U+0643.
Long central vowel	Produce ೃ (U+0627 U+065F). Recognise legacy ೄ during import, but do not generate it.
Short o vowel	Produce ೅ (U+0648 U+065A). Recognise visual alternatives only for compatibility.
Combining marks	Insert marks after their base character in memory. Preserve valid sequences during copy, paste, search and export.
Normalisation	Use Unicode NFC consistently, while treating documented Kashmiri legacy alternatives as equivalent during search.
Fonts	Use a modern font with Kashmiri coverage, such as a current Noto Nastaliq Urdu or compatible Naskh font.
Keyboard	Expose all letters, 12 essential marks, digits and punctuation; support aspirates as base letter + ೆ.

Complete keyboard-ready repertoire

ا، آ، اُ، اِ، ء، ب، پ، ت، ٹ، ث، ج، چ، ح، خ، د، ڈ، ذ، ر، ڑ، ز، ژ، س، ش، ص، ض، ط،
ظ، ع، غ، ف، ق، ک، گ، ل، م، ن، و، و، ہ، ہ، ی، ے، ی

بَ، بُ، پِ، پْ، بٓ، بی، بو، بی، پی، پُ، پھ، پھو، پھی، پھو

Authoritative references

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2. **The Unicode Consortium.** *The Unicode Standard, Arabic block U+0600-U+06FF*.
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3. **The Unicode Consortium.** *Arabic Script, Chapter 9* — including Arabic Letter Kashmiri Yeh.
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4. **Aazim, Mansour & Pournader.** *Proposal to add two Kashmiri characters and one annotation*, Unicode L2/09-176.
<https://www.unicode.org/L2/L2009/09176-kashmiri.pdf>
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<https://r12a.github.io/scripts/arab/ks.html>

This chart distinguishes the native core alphabet from additional loanword letters. Both groups are included because a production Kashmiri editor must allow users to type modern Kashmiri documents, names, quotations and borrowed vocabulary without missing characters.

On-screen and physical phonetic keyboard map

Each key shows the Latin key at top-left, its Shift output at top-right, and its normal Kashmiri output in the centre. The on-screen keyboard uses these same mappings.



Reading the map: pressing **m** produces **م**; Shift+m produces **م̐**. The top-left key produces **اَ**, while Shift produces the dedicated Kashmiri Yeh **ی**.

Dynamic phonetic typing reference

Direct Latin key mappings

Keys	Output	Letter
a / b / p	ا / ب / پ	alef / beh / peh
t / T	ت / ٹ	teh / tteh
d / D	د / ڈ	dal / ddal
j / c	ج / چ	jeem / cheh
s / z	س / ز	seen / zeh
k / g	ک / گ	kaf / gaf
l / m / n	ل / م / ن	lam / meem / noon
w / v	و	waw
r / y / h	ر / ی / ہ	reh / yeh / heh
q / f / x	ق / ف / خ	qaf / feh / kheh
e / i / u / o	ع / ا / ا / ا	carrier and vowel forms

Shift and Alt mappings

Keys	Output	Function
A / W / Y	آ / و / اے	vowel letters
Q / E / R	ص / اء / اڑ	additional letters
S / F / G	ش / اٹ / اغ	additional letters
H / J / K / L	ح / اض / اخ / اط	additional letters
Z / X / V	ژ / اذ / اظ	additional letters
B / N / M	بھ / اں / ام	aspirate / nasal / doubled meem
Alt+a / Alt+w	اُ / وُ	Kashmiri vowel letters
Alt+y / Alt+z	ی / ذ	Kashmiri Yeh / dhal
Alt+h / Alt+i	ہ / ے	central vowel marks
Alt+e / Alt+u	اُ / اِ	small V / inverted damma

Dynamic two-key sequences

aa آ	ae اُ	ii ی	uu وُ
oe و	sh ش	zh / ts ژ	gh غ
kh خ	ph / pH پھ	bh / bH بھ	th / tH تھ
TH ٹھ	ch چھ	kH کھ	ZH زھ

Uppercase H means aspiration: kH → کھ, while lowercase kh → خ. This keeps the native aspirated consonant distinct from the Arabic/Persian loan consonant. The editor dynamically replaces the preceding character without moving the caret.

Digits and punctuation

، ۱، ۲، ۳، ۴، ۵، ۶، ۷، ۸، ۹، ؟، %